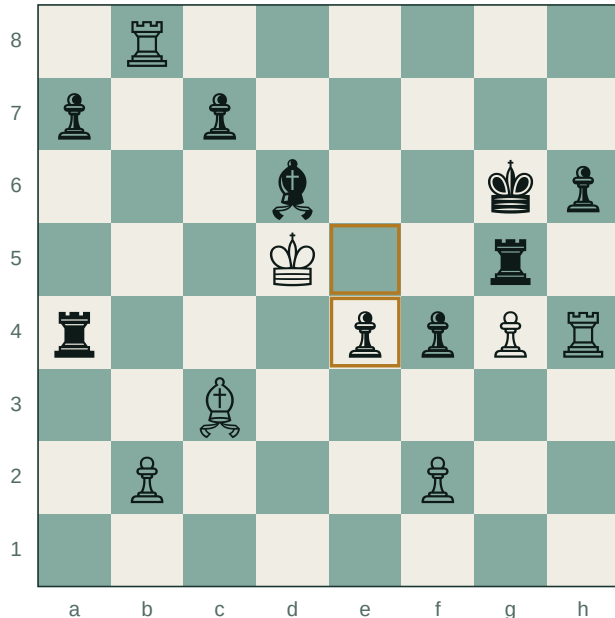


Active defensive resources: White, move 38

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 37...e4+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38. Ke6 Re5+ 39. Bxe5

38.Ke6 The king moves from d5 to e6. Recorded reply: **38...Re5+**.

39.Bxe5 The bishop captures the rook on e5.

At the end, nominal material is White 16 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g6. Geometrically undefended: rook on a4. Check for tactical protection.